

Morisco, Taj Fort Aguada Resort & Spa, Goa—2001

Where the Kitchen Meets the Sea

Every restaurant on this list has learned to hold a room. Morisco has learned something rarer: how to hold a coastline. Set right on Sinquerim Beach at Taj Fort Aguada, Morisco is an alfresco restaurant built around simple cane furniture, an interactive live kitchen, and a view of the Arabian Sea that does not need to compete with the plate. The setting could easily be the whole story. It isn't.

The kitchen's proposition is unapologetically Goan—crab, lobster, pomfret, squid and seabass, prepared with Portuguese-inflected technique and local spice, the four notes of Goan cuisine— sweet, sour, spicy, savoury—running through nearly every dish. Morisco's signature heritage lunch thalis distil that philosophy into a single sitting: a Seafood Thali built around dishes like Crab Xec-Xec and Mushroom Mardol, alongside a Meat Thali and a Saraswat Veg Thali, each served unlimited, and each finished with a Portuguese-style Serradura for dessert.

What sets Morisco apart from the grand dining rooms elsewhere in this feature is not ambition but temperament. There is
no chandelier to protect, no fresco to preserve, no decades-old table to point to. Its legacy is being written in real time—one sunset,
one fresh catch, one thali at a time—and it has chosen to write it outdoors, with sand nearly underfoot and the sea



doing most of the talking.

Signature Crab Xec-Xec, Mushroom Mardol, Goan seafood thalis, Portuguese Serradura

The Morisco lesson A restaurant doesn't need centuries to earn a sense of place. Sometimes the coastline creates the waves.

Meal for Two ₹5,000 plus taxes